

The Camargue

One of Europe's major coastal wetlands, famous for its semi-wild horses and cattle, designated a wetland of international importance



The Camargue is a vast wetland region located within the Rhône Delta—the largest river delta in Western Europe—on the south coast of France. It comprises more than 360 square miles (930 square km) of diverse habitats including salt marshes, sandbars, brackish lagoons, freshwater ponds, reedbeds, and low-lying islands. Many of these landforms are in a state of constant change, and the gradual accumulation of silt means the delta is steadily growing.

Historically, the Camargue has been prone to flooding, and a combination of dykes and canals has been built to help control the flow of water through the area. Large parts of the original wetlands at the periphery of the region have been drained for agricultural use, including the creation of rice paddies, which have been a feature of the

region since the Middle Ages. The salt marshes in the southeast section of the Camargue are a major center of commercial salt production.

Famous wildlife

The Camargue's best-known animals include its semi-wild white horses and black cattle. However, its remarkable birdlife is one of the region's greatest attractions. More than 300 species are found in the Camargue, and it is an important stopover for birds migrating between Europe and Africa.

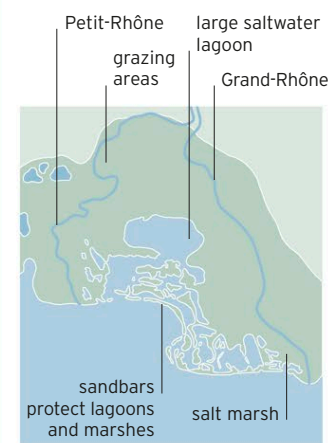


◀ REEDBED SPECIALIST

Attracted to reedbeds, the bearded reedling is also called the bearded tit. In summer it eats insects and larvae, and in winter it eats reed seeds.

COASTAL WETLAND

The Camargue is situated in a roughly triangular region between two arms of the Rhône Delta—the Petit-Rhône and Grand-Rhône—and the Mediterranean Sea. An area to the west of the western arm is known as Petite-Camargue.



▽ FLOCKING FLAMINGOS

The Camargue is home to a large population of greater flamingos, which feed on brine shrimps that thrive in brackish waters.

The **Camargue horse** is an **indigenous breed** that has lived here for **thousands of years**

